EA and HERM adoption survey of the EUNIS EA SIG

Welcome!

This survey explores the current adoption and use of Enterprise Architecture (EA) and the Higher Education Reference Model (HERM) in higher education, including practices, use cases, barriers, and support needs.
The study is conducted in close connection with the **EUNIS Enterprise Architecture Special Interest Group (EA SIG)**, which promotes knowledge sharing and collaborative development of EA practices across higher education.
The findings will be discussed with the EA SIG and used to support further community activities and publications.

Privacy and Data Protection

Participation in this survey is voluntary.
The data controller responsible for the processing of personal data is:
SemaLogic
Am Wäldchen 10
D-99435 Weimar
Germany
Represented by **Markus von der Heyde, CEO**.
Contact: markus.von.der.heyde at semalogic.de

The information collected through this survey will be used to analyse the adoption and use of Enterprise Architecture (EA) and the Higher Education

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Reference Model (HERM) in higher education. The study will be analysed by Markus von der Heyde on behalf of SemaLogic, discussed with the EUNIS Enterprise Architecture SIG, and subsequently published.
The legal basis for processing personal data is your consent pursuant to Art. 6(1)(a) GDPR. Contact details and other direct personal identifiers will not be included in the published research dataset. Exception: if you opt in to peer matching, your contact details will be shared only with peer institutions that have also opted in.
Before publication, the survey data will be de-identified. Data that could identify individuals or institutions will be removed or coarsened. The resulting dataset is intended to be published for long-term public access through the Zenodo community **"Research on Digital Transformation and Information Technology in Higher Education in Europe".** The published data may be downloaded, analysed and reused by third parties in accordance with the licence specified for the Zenodo record (CC-BY-NC-SA 4.0).

You may withdraw your consent at any time before publication of the dataset by contacting Markus von der Heyde at SemaLogic. Withdrawal does not affect the lawfulness of processing carried out before withdrawal. After publication on Zenodo, complete withdrawal of already published or downloaded data can no longer be guaranteed.
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How would you like to proceed?*

Please select one option:

- ◯ **Leave the survey without participating.** You may optionally tell us why on the final page.
- ◯ **Preview the questionnaire only.** My responses will not be included in the study.
- ◯ **Participate in the survey.** I have read the information above and voluntarily consent to the processing of my survey responses for the purposes described.

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ENTERPRISE ARCHITECTURE

Respondent & Institution Profile

You are previewing the questionnaire. Your answers decide which questions you see. If you only click "Next", you will skip most of the survey, including all questions on how HERM is used. To see the in-depth questions, choose "Established operational practice" as the status of Enterprise Architecture and "Active operational use" as the level of HERM adoption.

Institution name

If you prefer not to identify your institution, leave this field blank.

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Country

Which country is your institution based in?
Hint: try typing your ISO code (DE -> Germany, FI -> Suomi/Finland etc.)

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- ◯ AD - Andorra
- ◯ AL - Shqipëria
- ◯ AT - Österreich
- ◯ BA - Bosna i Hercegovina / Босна и Херцеговина
- ◯ BE - België / Belgique / Belgien
- ◯ BG - България
- ◯ BY - Беларусь
- ◯ CH - Schweiz / Suisse / Svizzera / Svizra
- ◯ CY - Κύπρος / Kıbrıs
- ◯ CZ - Česko
- ◯ DE - Deutschland
- ◯ DK - Danmark
- ◯ EE - Eesti
- ◯ ES - España
- ◯ FI - Suomi / Finland
- ◯ FR - France
- ◯ GB - United Kingdom
- ◯ GR - Ελλάδα
- ◯ HR - Hrvatska
- ◯ HU - Magyarország
- ◯ IE - Éire / Ireland

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- ◯ IS - Ísland
- ◯ IT - Italia
- ◯ LI - Liechtenstein
- ◯ LT - Lietuva
- ◯ LU - Lëtzebuerg / Luxembourg / Luxemburg
- ◯ LV - Latvija
- ◯ MC - Monaco
- ◯ MD - Moldova
- ◯ ME - Crna Gora / Црна Гора
- ◯ MK - Северна Македонија / Maqedonia e Veriut
- ◯ MT - Malta
- ◯ NL - Nederland
- ◯ NO - Norge / Noreg
- ◯ PL - Polska
- ◯ PT - Portugal
- ◯ RO - România
- ◯ RS - Србија / Srbija
- ◯ RU - Россия
- ◯ SE - Sverige
- ◯ SI - Slovenija
- ◯ SK - Slovensko

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- SM - San Marino
- TR - Türkiye
- UA - Україна

Specific Country

Please state the country in which your institution is based.

Institution type

- University
- Specialised higher education institution
- Research institution
- University of Applied Sciences / Polytechnic
- Arts or Music institution
- Don't know / Cannot assess
- Other

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Approximate number of students

Report head count.

- ◯ Fewer than 1,000
- ◯ 1,000–4,999
- ◯ 5,000–9,999
- ◯ 10,000–19,999
- ◯ 20,000–39,999
- ◯ 40,000–79,999
- ◯ 80,000 or more
- ◯ Not applicable
- ◯ Don't know

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Approximate staff headcount

- ◯ Fewer than 250
- ◯ 250–999
- ◯ 1,000–2,499
- ◯ 2,500–4,999
- ◯ 5,000–9,999
- ◯ 10,000 or more
- ◯ Don't know

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Your role

- [ ] Enterprise / Business / Solution / IT Architect
- [ ] IT Strategy / Digital Strategy
- [ ] CIO / IT Director / Head of IT
- [ ] CDO / Digital Office
- [ ] IT or Digital Project / Programme Management
- [ ] Academic / Researcher with EA context
- [ ] Educator / Lecturer with EA context
- [ ] Other

_____

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Your organisational unit

In which part of your institution do you mainly work?

- [ ] Central IT
- [ ] Central administration or services outside IT (incl. executive or strategy office)
- [ ] Decentralised IT in a faculty, department or institute
- [ ] Faculty, department or institute (outside IT)
- [ ] External to the institution (e.g. consultant)
- [ ] Other

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Your knowledge of your institution's EA practice

- ◯ I am directly responsible for or actively involved in it
- ◯ I work closely with the EA practice
- ◯ I have general knowledge of it
- ◯ I have limited knowledge of it

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Enterprise Architecture Practice

Current status of Enterprise Architecture at your institution

To the best of your knowledge, what is the current status of Enterprise Architecture at your institution?

If the status differs between parts of your institution (e.g. central units vs. faculties), please answer for the most advanced part.

- ◯ Established operational practice
- ◯ Early operational practice / currently being established
- ◯ Exploring or planning EA
- ◯ No EA practice
- ◯ Don't know / Cannot assess

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Enterprise Architecture Practice Details

Coverage of EA across organisational areas

In higher education, EA often covers some parts of the institution more than others.
For each of the following areas, what is the current status of EA?

	Established	Early operational	Exploring or planning	No EA	Don't know / n.a.
Central IT (e.g. IT services, infrastructure, IT governance)	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯
Central administration and services outside IT (e.g. student administration, finance, HR)	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯
Decentralised IT in faculties, departments or institutes	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯
Faculties, departments, institutes (organisation of teaching and research, local processes)	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

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Other (please name) _____	○	○	○	○	○

Organisational age of the EA practice

Approximately how long has your institution had an operational EA practice?

- ○ Less than 1 year
- ○ 1–3 years
- ○ 4–7 years
- ○ More than 7 years
- ○ Don't know

EA approaches currently used

Which of the following frameworks/methods/etc. does your institution currently use, pilot, or actively evaluate for Enterprise Architecture?

For the following questions, you can select more than one option.

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EA frameworks / methods

- [ ] Zachman Framework
- [ ] TOGAF
- [ ] Don't know / Cannot assess
- [ ] Other EA framework or method

_____

Higher-education reference models / architectures

- [ ] HORA / HOSA
- [ ] HERM
- [ ] Don't know / Cannot assess
- [ ] Other higher-education reference model

_____

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Modelling languages / standards

- [ ] BPMN
- [ ] ArchiMate
- [ ] Don't know / Cannot assess
- [ ] Other modelling language or notation

Institution-specific approach

- [ ] No formal framework; pragmatic or ad hoc EA practice
- [ ] Just EA standards without customisation
- [ ] Custom / in-house EA framework
- [ ] Don't know / Cannot assess
- [ ] Other

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Organisational home of the EA practice

Where is the EA practice organisationally located or formally anchored?

You can select more than one option.

- [ ] Dedicated Enterprise Architecture team
- [ ] CIO office / IT leadership
- [ ] Academic / teaching organisation
- [ ] Research organisation
- [ ] Undefined
- [ ] Central administration outside IT
- [ ] CDO / Digital Office
- [ ] Cross-institutional / distributed model
- [ ] Central IT
- [ ] Don't know / Cannot assess
- [ ] Other

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Executive or organisational lead for EA

Who has primary organisational responsibility for Enterprise Architecture?

- ◯ Distributed / shared responsibility without one formal lead
- ◯ CIO
- ◯ Vice-President / Vice-Rector / Executive Board member
- ◯ Dedicated Head of Enterprise Architecture / Chief Architect
- ◯ CDO / Head of Digital Transformation
- ◯ Central administration leader outside IT
- ◯ IT Director / Head of IT
- ◯ Undefined
- ◯ Don't know / Cannot assess
- ◯ Other

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HERM Awareness & Adoption

Respondent awareness of HERM

Before starting this survey, how familiar were you personally with HERM?

- ◯ I know HERM well
- ◯ I know the basic concept
- ◯ I had heard of HERM but knew little about it
- ◯ I was not familiar with HERM before this survey

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Institutional HERM adoption status

To the best of your knowledge, what is the highest current level of HERM adoption at your institution?

- ◯ Not considered
- ◯ Being evaluated / considered
- ◯ Pilot or experimental use
- ◯ Active operational use
- ◯ Embedded in governance or standard EA processes
- ◯ Previously used, but no longer in use
- ◯ Don't know / Cannot assess

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HERM Usage Details

Duration of HERM engagement

Approximately how long has your institution been actively evaluating or using HERM?

- ◯ Less than 1 year
- ◯ 1–3 years
- ◯ 4–7 years
- ◯ More than 7 years
- ◯ Don't know

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HERM application area

In which areas of your organisation are HERM artefacts used?

- [ ] Teaching and learning (as topic)
- [ ] Finance and controlling
- [ ] Facilities / infrastructure
- [ ] IT management
- [ ] Research (as topic)
- [ ] Human resources
- [ ] Governance / strategy
- [ ] Student lifecycle / student administration
- [ ] Institution-wide / cross-domain
- [ ] Don't know / Cannot assess
- [ ] Other

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HERM artefacts used or evaluated

Which HERM artefacts does your institution currently use, pilot, or actively evaluate?

	Operational	Pilot	Evaluating	Not used	Don't know / n.a.
Business Reference Model (BRM)	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯
Data Reference Model (DRM)	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯
Application Reference Model (ARM)	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯
Service Reference Model (SRM)	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯
Technology Reference Model (TRM)	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

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Additional artefacts used

Which EAM and HERM-related/supporting artefacts and approaches are in use?

- [ ] Recipe Cards
- [ ] Value Streams
- [ ] Process Models
- [ ] Business Model Canvas
- [ ] Don't know / Cannot assess
- [ ] Other

Primary HERM application area

Which is currently the primary area? Provide HERM Business Capability name or other HERM identifier, if known.

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Problems and tasks addressed with HERM

For which tasks is HERM currently used or evaluated at your institution?

- [ ] Service design or service architecture
- [ ] Communication between IT and non-IT stakeholders
- [ ] Structuring or documenting the application landscape
- [ ] Consolidation, merger, or shared-service planning
- [ ] Structuring or communicating business capabilities
- [ ] Impact analysis and future-state planning for major change initiatives
- [ ] Strategic or transformation planning
- [ ] Benchmarking or comparison with peer institutions
- [ ] Investment or project portfolio planning and prioritisation
- [ ] Technology standardisation or technology lifecycle management
- [ ] Risk, security, or compliance analysis
- [ ] Process or responsibility modelling
- [ ] Data governance or data architecture
- [ ] Don't know / Cannot assess
- [ ] Other

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Value received from using HERM

What specific value can you now offer your organisation?

- [ ] No tangible outcome yet
- [ ] Improved stakeholder communication
- [ ] Cost or effort reduction
- [ ] Improved landscape transparency
- [ ] Accelerated project or analysis
- [ ] Shared terminology
- [ ] Reusable architecture artefact
- [ ] Better decision support
- [ ] Don't know / Cannot assess
- [ ] Other

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Your HERM use case

Note:

The following question is at the core of the entire initiative because we are most interested in how HERM is applied in various Higher Education Institutions. We appreciate the time and effort you have put into your answer.

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Concrete HERM use case

Please describe one specific HERM use case at your institution that you know particularly well. Please focus on what was actually done rather than on HERM in general.

You may use the following points as guidance:

- **Use case:** What was the problem, task, or decision?
- **Actors:** Who was involved?
- **HERM use:** Which HERM artefact(s) were used, and how were they applied?
- **Outcome:** What was produced, decided, or changed?
- **Benefit:** Who benefited from the result, and in what way?

A concise description is sufficient; you do not need to address every point.

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Evaluate HERM Usage

What has worked well?

What aspects of using HERM have worked particularly well at your institution?

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Enabling factors

What factors enabled the implementation of HERM at your institution?

- [ ] Tool support
- [ ] Executive sponsorship
- [ ] Concrete institutional use case
- [ ] Availability of reusable examples
- [ ] Individual champion or internal advocate
- [ ] Alignment with existing EA models
- [ ] Good documentation
- [ ] Active practitioner community
- [ ] National / community support
- [ ] Strong EA capability
- [ ] Don't know / Cannot assess
- [ ] Other

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What has been difficult or missing?

What aspects of using HERM have been difficult, insufficient, or missing?

Integration of HERM into broader EA practice

What role does HERM play in your institution's broader EA practice?

- ◯ Central foundation of the EA approach
- ◯ Integrated component of the EA approach
- ◯ Selectively connected for specific use cases
- ◯ Used independently of the broader EA practice
- ◯ No relationship established yet
- ◯ Don't know / Cannot assess

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Adapted, extended or mapped HERM

Have you adapted, extended or mapped HERM in a way that might be useful to other institutions?

- [ ] Visualisation
- [ ] Data mapping
- [ ] HORA mapping
- [ ] Service catalogue
- [ ] Capability extensions
- [ ] Application mapping
- [ ] Governance model
- [ ] Translation
- [ ] Tool implementation
- [ ] Don't know / Cannot assess
- [ ] Other

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HERM Non-Adoption & Barriers

Reasons HERM is not currently in operational use

Which factors currently contribute to HERM not being used operationally at your institution?

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- [ ] HERM is not sufficiently known at our institution
- [ ] EA/HERM knowledge depends on too few individuals
- [ ] Benefits are unclear compared with the required effort
- [ ] HERM was previously used but discontinued
- [ ] Switching or adoption effort is too high
- [ ] HERM appears too complex for our current needs
- [ ] HERM appears too specific for our context
- [ ] Insufficient tooling support
- [ ] Insufficient documentation or guidance
- [ ] Existing EA approaches already meet our needs
- [ ] Insufficient internal EA capacity
- [ ] Lack of implementation examples / peer cases
- [ ] HERM does not appear to fit our institutional context
- [ ] No current need for an additional reference model
- [ ] Lack of leadership or organisational support
- [ ] Don't know / Cannot assess
- [ ] Other

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Primary barrier

Of the factors you selected, which is currently the most important barrier?

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- ◯ HERM is not sufficiently known at our institution
- ◯ HERM appears too complex for our current needs
- ◯ Lack of leadership or organisational support
- ◯ HERM was previously used but discontinued
- ◯ Switching or adoption effort is too high
- ◯ Insufficient internal EA capacity
- ◯ Existing EA approaches already meet our needs
- ◯ Insufficient tooling support
- ◯ Benefits are unclear compared with the required effort
- ◯ Insufficient documentation or guidance
- ◯ No current need for an additional reference model
- ◯ HERM does not appear to fit our institutional context
- ◯ Lack of implementation examples / peer cases
- ◯ EA/HERM knowledge depends on too few individuals
- ◯ HERM appears too specific for our context
- ◯ Other (meaning the item you provided above)
- ◯ None of the above
- ◯ Don't know / Cannot assess

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Future consideration of HERM

Is there currently an intention or plan to evaluate or pilot HERM within the next two years?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ Under discussion
- ◯ No
- ◯ Don't know / Cannot assess

Potential role of HERM

If your institution adopted HERM, what role would it most likely play?

- ◯ Foundation for the overall EA approach
- ◯ Complement to an existing EA framework or method
- ◯ Reference model for selected domains or use cases
- ◯ Primarily a benchmarking / comparison reference
- ◯ Don't know / Cannot assess
- ◯ Other

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Requirements for future adoption

What would HERM need to offer, or what would need to change at your institution, for adoption to become more attractive?

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Open Questions & Support Needs

Open questions about Enterprise Architecture

What are the most important unresolved questions about Enterprise Architecture at your institution?

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Open questions about HERM

What questions about HERM would you most like the HERM community to address?

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Support needs

What support from the EA and HERM community would help your institution advance EA?

- [ ] None currently
- [ ] Peer exchange with other institutions
- [ ] Tooling support
- [ ] Concrete use cases and examples
- [ ] Reference architectures / reusable patterns
- [ ] Mapping to other EA frameworks or standards
- [ ] Implementation guide / playbook
- [ ] Governance and organisational guidance
- [ ] Introductory guidance
- [ ] Benchmarking data
- [ ] Training or workshops
- [ ] Don't know / Cannot assess
- [ ] Other

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Most important support need

Which of these would be most valuable to your institution?

- ◯ Implementation guide / playbook
- ◯ Introductory guidance
- ◯ Tooling support
- ◯ Training or workshops
- ◯ Reference architectures / reusable patterns
- ◯ Concrete use cases and examples
- ◯ Peer exchange with other institutions
- ◯ Governance and organisational guidance
- ◯ Benchmarking data
- ◯ Mapping to other EA frameworks or standards
- ◯ Other (meaning the item you provided above)
- ◯ None of the above
- ◯ Don't know / Cannot assess

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Knowledge Sharing & Follow-up

Potential value of the institution's experience

Do you believe your institution has an EA or HERM experience that could be useful for other higher education institutions?

◯ Yes	◯ Possibly	◯ Unlikely	◯ No	◯ Don't know / Cannot assess

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Interest in community exchange

Would you or your institution be interested in any of the following?

- [ ] Joining a community workgroup on EA / HERM
- [ ] Presenting and discussing your EA / HERM work
- [ ] Participating in a more detailed follow-up survey
- [ ] Sharing a use case or practical experience
- [ ] Receiving the results of this survey
- [ ] Being connected with peer institutions that have a similar EA setup (peer matching)
- [ ] Participating in a follow-up interview
- [ ] None of these

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Contact e-mail

By providing your contact details, you consent to the purpose(s) provided in the previous question.

Please note that your response will not be included in the publication of the dataset. It will only be processed internally by SemaLogic and the EUNIS EA SIG. If you selected peer matching, your contact details will be shared only with peer institutions that have also selected peer matching.

Permission to name institution

You had provided the name of your institution at the beginning of this survey. This may in connection with your role lead reveal your identity.

May your institution be named in publications or datasets resulting from this survey?

- ◯ Yes, the institution may be named, and I understand that this may identify me
- ◯ No, do not name the institution; publish my responses only in de-identified or aggregated form

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Closing & Feedback

Thank you for your time.
We will evaluate, discuss and publish the results as soon as possible.

Feedback

Do you have any final comments about the survey itself?
If you chose not to participate, we would appreciate a short note on why.

Thank you again for your personal support of the global HERM community!

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